

ASUS Eee PC1008HA

The most amazing thing about the Seashell 1008HA is the design, which is based on its name—rounded and clamshell-like. Measuring just 27mm at its broadest point, and getting considerably thinner towards the front of the chassis, you'll hardly notice the 1008HA Seashell in your bag, which is also because it weighs just over 1 kg.

Display

The 10-inch (25.4 cm) screen is a joy to use. It features an average resolution of 1024 x 600 pixels, but images appear perfectly crisp, and the colour reproduction is flawless. That said, the glossy Super-TFT coating can make it difficult to view in the brightest conditions, with reflections proving problematic.

Design

Despite the Eee PC 1008HA's compact footprint, it features a well-spaced keyboard that stretches right to the edge of the chassis. The keys are 92 per cent full-sized, and feature a flat design with slightly tapered edges. It's not the best netbook keyboard we've seen, but it works well, and is very tough. It's also a comfortable option when typing for longer periods.

A high quality standard runs throughout, although the high-gloss plastics do attract fingerprints more than rival products, and you'll have to use the protective case

provided if you want to keep it looking new. The svelte lines are enhanced by hidden ports, protected by plastic covers. This feature doesn't help usability; however, with access proving slightly tricky.



▲ All the ports are stylishly covered to prevent dust and to give it a finished look

Ports

Behind the covers you'll find a USB port on each side of the chassis, and on the left sits a mini-VGA port. It's the first time we've seen one of these in action, but thankfully an adapter is provided as standard, slotted neatly underneath

the chassis. On the other side, you'll also find microphone and headphone sockets, and an Ethernet port.



▲ The lan port is placed too far away at the corner to make it a bit inconvenient

Storage

The ASUS also impresses when it comes to storage space, with a capacious 160 GB hard drive included as standard. You'll find an additional 10 GB of online storage provided—offering better protection for your most important files, with no risk of damage if anything happens to the netbook itself.

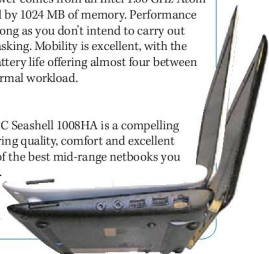
The processor

Processing power comes from an Intel 1.66 GHz Atom processor, backed by 1024 MB of memory. Performance is reasonable, as long as you don't intend to carry out intensive multi-tasking. Mobility is excellent, with the compact 3-cell battery life offering almost four between charges under normal workload.

Verdict

Overall, the Eee PC Seashell 1008HA is a compelling proposition. Offering quality, comfort and excellent mobility, it's one of the best mid-range netbooks you can currently buy.

Comparison between 1005HA and 1008HA ►



THE COMPLETE MAGAZINE ON OPEN SOURCE

LINUX

BETA
ForYou

Your favourite Linux Magazine is
now on the Web, too.

LinuxForU.com

Follow us on Twitter @LinuxForYou